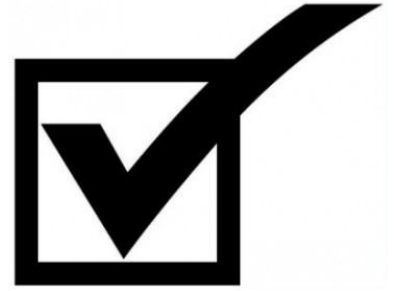


**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



SMALL BUSINESS MANAGEMENT TEAM

(510)

NATIONAL 2025

FINAL

GENERAL GUIDELINES

1. **Formulate Questions:** As a team of judges, create two to three questions to ask at the end of each presentation. *Make sure to ask the same questions to every team.*
2. **Presentation Details:**
 - a. **Setup Time:** Teams have up to 3 minutes to set up.
 - b. **Presentation Time:** Each team has up to 10 minutes to present, followed by up to 10 minutes for judges' questions.
 - c. **Completion:** Excuse the teams after the judges' questions are finished.
3. **Judging Rules:**
 - a. **No Ties:** There can be no ties in the top 10 teams. Judges are responsible for breaking any ties.
 - b. **Ranking:** The administrator will fill out the ranking sheet before dismissing the judges.
4. **Post-Presentation:**
 - a. **Materials:** Give all Judges' Rating Sheets, Judge Evaluation Sheets, and contest materials to the administrator.
5. **Audience:** No audience is allowed in the contest room.

INITIAL CASE STUDY TOPIC

Innovation Retail, a well-established chain of brick-and-mortar retail stores, is grappling with declining sales due to the surge in e-commerce. The stores, located in a city of 550,000 people, employ eight full-time employees at each of their four locations located in different parts of the city. The hours of operation at each store are Monday – Friday from 9:00 a.m. – 5:30 p.m., Saturday from 9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m., and closed on Sunday.

Over the past two years, in-store sales have dropped significantly: by 27% at store 1, 24% at store 2, and 19% at store 3. At the fourth store's location, there was a slight increase in sales of 15%. CEO Matthew Lawrence has decided to embark on a digital transformation project to integrate online and offline shopping experiences, tasking project manager Monroe Lewis and his team with leading this initiative. However, due to the continued decrease in sales and multiple attempts to generate additional income, discussions are now taking place about potentially cutting employees at each location. Even though total sales decreased at three stores, each full-time salesperson was paid a 20% commission on every purchase plus a bonus.

Internal Challenges

- Employee morale
- Employee digital skills gap
- Balancing resources between physical stores and developing the digital platform
- Employee costs

External Challenges

- Technology adoption
- E-commerce competition
- Economic factors
- Changing consumer behavior

As a team, you will develop a plan with different strategies for Monroe Lewis and his team to employ to help Innovation Retail be more profitable. While developing your plan, consider the following questions:

- How can Innovation Retail use its physical stores to make online shopping better and attract more customers?
- What online marketing methods can help bring more people to both the website and the physical stores?
- What new technology is needed to connect online and in-store shopping smoothly?
- How can Innovation Retail make customers more loyal and keep them coming back?
- What ways can Innovation Retail save money without hurting employee morale or customer service?

MODIFICATION

As Innovation Retail strives to navigate these compounded challenges, an unforeseen internal conflict arises. Key members of the management team clash over the direction of the company's strategy, leading to delays in decision-making and implementation. Additionally, a critical technological failure occurs during the rollout of the new e-commerce platform, causing the site to go offline for several days and resulting in lost sales and frustrated customers.

POTENTIAL JUDGE'S QUESTIONS

1. What contingency plans could address potential delays in the implementation of critical projects?
2. How will the management team communicate the resolution of these conflicts to employees and stakeholders to maintain confidence?
3. How will the company manage the operational challenges caused by the internal conflicts and technological failure?